

Consulting English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: management consultants, strategy consultants, implementation consultants, analysts, engagement managers, client partners, internal consultants, and advisory teams

Focus: A consulting English curriculum for discovery, hypotheses, stakeholder management, scope, executive recommendations, slide narratives, implementation risk, and client pushback.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Client Discovery and Problem Definition

Situation

A client asks for a benchmark study but describes a decision problem.

Stakeholder pressure: Sell the requested benchmark.

Constraint: Decision question, stakeholders, constraints, and expected use of analysis need clarification.

Terms to use

- discovery
- problem statement
- decision question
- stakeholder

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A client asks for a benchmark study but describes a decision problem.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Sell the requested benchmark.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects problem statement.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a discovery question guide.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects problem statement.

Option	Phrase
A	discovery
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Sell the requested benchmark.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify discovery and problem statement against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A client asks for a benchmark study but describes a decision problem. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
C	evidence threshold
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discovery question guide with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 2. Hypotheses and Issue Trees

Situation

The team has limited data but needs a workplan.

Stakeholder pressure: Analyze everything.

Constraint: Hypotheses, issue tree, prioritization, and evidence plan should focus effort.

Terms to use

- hypothesis
- issue tree
- workstream
- evidence plan

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The team has limited data but needs a workplan.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Analyze everything.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects issue tree.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a issue-tree workplan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects issue tree.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	hypothesis
C	evidence plan
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Analyze everything.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify hypothesis and issue tree against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - The team has limited data but needs a workplan. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the issue-tree workplan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 3. Data Requests and Client Burden

Situation

The consulting team sends a long data request to a busy client.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask for everything just in case.

Constraint: Data relevance, owner, confidentiality, deadline, and burden need management.

Terms to use

- data request
- confidentiality
- owner

- deadline

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The consulting team sends a long data request to a busy client.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask for everything just in case.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects confidentiality.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a data request prioritization.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects confidentiality.

Option	Phrase
A	deadline
B	data request
C	confidentiality
D	owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask for everything just in case.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify data request and confidentiality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - The consulting team sends a long data request to a busy client. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
C	evidence threshold

Option	Phrase
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the data request prioritization with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 4. Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis

Situation

A deck has many charts but no decision narrative.

Stakeholder pressure: Add more detail.

Constraint: So-what, implication, recommendation, and decision ask must be explicit.

Terms to use

- storyline
- so what
- recommendation
- decision ask

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A deck has many charts but no decision narrative.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Add more detail.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects so what.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a executive storyline.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects so what.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	storyline

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Add more detail.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify storyline and so what against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve storyline after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A deck has many charts but no decision narrative. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the executive storyline with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	decision owner
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Module 5. Scope Management and Change Requests

Situation

A client asks for an additional market study mid-project.

Stakeholder pressure: Do it to keep the client happy.

Constraint: Scope, timeline, budget, value, and tradeoff need a formal conversation.

Terms to use

- scope
- change request
- tradeoff
- statement of work

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A client asks for an additional market study mid-project.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Do it to keep the client happy.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects change request.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a scope-change response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects change request.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	scope
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Do it to keep the client happy.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	evidence threshold
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify scope and change request against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	A scope-change response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A client asks for an additional market study mid-project. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the scope-change response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 6. Difficult Client Feedback

Situation

A client says the recommendation is not practical.

Stakeholder pressure: Defend the model.

Constraint: Implementation constraints, assumptions, and client knowledge should be integrated.

Terms to use

- assumption
- implementation constraint
- stakeholder buy-in

- iteration

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A client says the recommendation is not practical.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Defend the model.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects implementation constraint.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a feedback recovery plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects implementation constraint.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	implementation constraint
D	assumption

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Defend the model.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify assumption and implementation constraint against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A client says the recommendation is not practical. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner

Option	Phrase
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the feedback recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 7. Implementation and Change Management

Situation

Leadership approves a new operating model but managers resist.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell managers the decision is final.

Constraint: Change story, incentives, decision rights, training, and adoption metrics matter.

Terms to use

- operating model
- change management
- adoption
- decision rights

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Leadership approves a new operating model but managers resist.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell managers the decision is final.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects change management.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a implementation risk brief.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects change management.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	operating model
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell managers the decision is final.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A implementation risk brief is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify operating model and change management against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve operating model after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Leadership approves a new operating model but managers resist. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the implementation risk brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Module 8. Steering Committees and Final Readouts

Situation

Executives disagree during the final readout.

Stakeholder pressure: Keep presenting the slides.

Constraint: Decision rights, options, risks, and next-step ownership need facilitation.

Terms to use

- steering committee
- option set
- risk
- next step

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Executives disagree during the final readout.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Keep presenting the slides.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects option set.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a steering committee close.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects option set.

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	steering committee
C	decision owner
D	option set

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Keep presenting the slides.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A steering committee close is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify steering committee and option set against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve steering committee after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Executives disagree during the final readout. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the steering committee close with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Client Discovery and Problem Definition - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. discovery	'discovery' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Client Discovery and Problem Definition - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify discovery and problem statement against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Client Discovery and Problem Definition - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discovery question guide with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Hypotheses and Issue Trees - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. hypothesis	'hypothesis' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Hypotheses and Issue Trees - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify hypothesis and issue tree against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Hypotheses and Issue Trees - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the issue-tree workplan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Data Requests and Client Burden - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. data request	'data request' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Data Requests and Client Burden - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify data request and confidentiality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Data Requests and Client Burden - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the data request prioritization with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. storyline	'storyline' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify storyline and so what against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Slide Storylines and Executive Synthesis - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the executive storyline with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Scope Management and Change Requests - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. scope	'scope' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Scope Management and Change Requests - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify scope and change request against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Scope Management and Change Requests - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the scope-change response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Difficult Client Feedback - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. assumption	'assumption' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Difficult Client Feedback - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify assumption and implementation constraint against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Difficult Client Feedback - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the feedback recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Implementation and Change Management - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. operating model	'operating model' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Implementation and Change Management - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify operating model and change management against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Implementation and Change Management - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the implementation risk brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Steering Committees and Final Readouts - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. steering committee	'steering committee' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Steering Committees and Final Readouts - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify steering committee and option set against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Steering Committees and Final Readouts - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the steering committee close with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.